

Product Review

OVERVIEW

Product name: ZORYVE (roflumilast) cream 0.3%

Category: Rx, topical prescription product

Vehicle/form: Cream

Skin or hair type: Suitable for diverse skin types, including sensitive skin and skin folds. Works on hairline/edges; not ideal for dense scalp hair compared with foam.

Used for: Plaque psoriasis in adults and pediatric patients 6 years of age and older.

Black-owned business: No

Certified cruelty-free: No

Certified organic: No

Vegan: No



KEY FINDINGS



SAFETY

Low Risk

Generally safe. Product ingredients have low irritancy or allergy potential.



RESEARCH / DATA AVAILABLE

Limited

There is limited published data on the use of this product or its ingredients by the Black community.

RECOMMENDATION: This product is generally safe when used according to the label instructions. Do not use it if you have moderate to severe liver disease. If you are breastfeeding, keep it off the nipple/areola and avoid treating large areas. Use it on the skin only; do not apply to the eyes, mouth, or inside the vagina. Tell your clinician if you take strong CYP3A4 or dual CYP3A4/CYP1A2 inhibitors, or specific oral contraceptives (gestodene/ethinyl estradiol), because these can affect how the medicine is processed. Stop and contact a clinician if you get hives or severe irritation.

The limited amount of research available indicates itch relief may begin within days and visible improvement can build over 2–4 weeks, with most benefit around 6–8 weeks when used as directed. Because research specific to adults with Black skin is limited, pay close attention to how your skin responds and discuss any unexpected changes with a clinician.

SUPPORTING DATA AND ANALYSIS

Key Area	Findings
Active ingredients	Roflumilast 0.3% (PDE4 inhibitor)
Inactive ingredients	Ceteareth-10 phosphate; cetearyl phosphate; cetearyl (cetostearyl) alcohol; diethylene glycol monoethyl ether (ethoxydiglycol); hexylene glycol; isopropyl palmitate; methylparaben; propylparaben; purified water; sodium hydroxide; white petrolatum; hydrochloric acid (may be added to adjust pH)

Formulation concerns	• Contraindications and material toxicities: Do not use in moderate to severe liver disease (Child-Pugh B/C). Limited pregnancy data; if breastfeeding, avoid nipple/areola and large areas. • Major allergens: Parabens (methyl, propyl) and cetearyl alcohol can rarely cause allergy; stop and seek care if hives or a spreading rash occur. • Irritation-prone zones: Thin skin and body folds may sting during the first week. Use a thin layer on clean, dry skin and minimize friction and heat. • Acne/buildup risk: Isopropyl palmitate may trigger breakouts along hairline, beard, chest, or back if you're acne-prone; keep layers light and avoid heavy occlusion. • Absorption and medicines: Very large areas or occlusion can raise absorption. Tell your clinician about strong CYP3A4 or dual CYP3A4/CYP1A2 inhibitors and gestodene/ethinyl estradiol oral contraceptives.
Research and ingredient analysis	• What the active does: roflumilast reduces inflammatory signals in the skin that lead to plaques, itch, and redness. • Expected timeline: itch relief may begin within days; visible improvement commonly builds over 2–4 weeks, with most benefit around 6–8 weeks when used consistently. • Application sites: suitable for sensitive areas and skin folds where long-term steroid use can be problematic. • Fit for Black skin: study programs that included Black/African American participants and darker skin tones show meaningful improvement with once-daily use, with no treatment-related lightening or darkening reported.
Data sources to consider	• FDA label, Zoryve cream (2024): https://www.accessdata.fda.gov/drugsatfda_docs/label/2024/215985s007lbl.pdf • DailyMed, Zoryve cream: https://dailymed.nlm.nih.gov/dailymed/drugInfo.cfm?setid=ec1bb0d1-f38a-4080-831a-68791d1dfdb • DERMIS phase 3 trials (cream): https://jamanetwork.com/journals/jama/fullarticle/2796379 • PubMed (DERMIS): https://pubmed.ncbi.nlm.nih.gov/36125472/ • Long-term open-label extension: https://www.jaad.org/article/S0190-9622(24)00541-3/fulltext • PubMed (long-term extension): https://pubmed.ncbi.nlm.nih.gov/38556093/ • FDA topical review (class/PK context): https://www.fda.gov/media/188146/download • Foam phase 3 for scalp/body (hair-bearing sites context): https://jamanetwork.com/journals/jamadermatology/fullarticle/2833460 • Skin-of-color psoriasis update: https://psoriasisiscouncil.org/wp-content/uploads/2025/02/Int-J-Dermatology-2025-Gkini-Psoriasis-in-People-With-Skin-of-Color-An-Evidence%E2%80%90Based-Update.pdf • FDA parabens overview (preservatives context): https://www.fda.gov/cosmetics/cosmetic-ingredients/parabens-cosmetics • CADTH clinical review (independent appraisal): https://www.ncbi.nlm.nih.gov/books/NBK600013/

— See the legend on page 3 for a description of our scoring system. —

Last reviewed: September 2025

UNDERSTANDING YOUR RESULTS

WeSeeColor evaluates products by examining the ingredients listed on product labels and reviewing available scientific research and literature on both the products and their individual ingredients. Each product is rated on a 5-point scale, considering ingredient safety (and the potential for adverse reactions), the availability of data and research, and documented efficacy on Black skin and hair, when available.

SAFETY RATING

Very High Risk	High Risk	Moderate Risk	Low Risk	Very Low Risk
				
Caution. Strong likelihood that this product may cause irritation and/or an allergic reaction. Seek medical attention if exposed.	This product may cause irritation and/or an allergic reaction. Be careful and consult your physician.	In certain situations, this product may cause irritation or an allergic reaction. Speak with your physician to learn more.	Generally safe. Product ingredients have low irritancy or allergy potential.	Safe to use on most occasions. Product ingredients have negligible irritancy or allergy potential.

RESEARCH / DATA AVAILABILITY RATING

None	Limited	Fair	Good	Robust
				
There is no data on this product or ingredients used in the Black community.	There is limited published data on this product or ingredients used in the Black community.	There is a fair amount of published data or documented usage in the Black community.	Product or its ingredients have been studied extensively or used extensively in the Black community.	This product or its ingredients have been studied extensively, used extensively, and known in the Black community.

GENERAL CONSIDERATIONS

- Dietary supplements can have unexpected interactions with other products, drugs, or conditions. If the product is characterized as a dietary supplement, we recommend starting with a small intake and monitoring for potential side or adverse effects and consult with a licensed professional before resuming use.
- Allergens may sometimes be listed in labels using their scientific name (e.g. “arachis hypogaea oil” for “peanut oil”). Familiarize yourself with the scientific name of any ingredient to which you may be allergic and review the label carefully before starting usage.